minjokherald

June 20th, 2013 | Volume 28. No.1 48th edition | Publisher Yun Chung-il (headmaster)

OF THE STUDENTS
BY THE STUDENTS and
FOR THE STUDENTS

Editor-in-Chief
Lee Eun-Ji

Editing Supervisor
Jeong Seon-Hee

Faculty Advisor
Neil Tweedie

Writing Crew
Lee Hye-Joon
Lee Sung-Jin
Park Ye-Ji
Kim Sol
Sung Yoo-Sun
Kim Byeong-Yun
Kim Ji-Ho
Kim Ri-Hyun
Lim Kyung-Bin
Lee Chang-Hun
Lee Jin-Kyu
Park So-Hyun

Feature Crew
Kim Hyun-Jee
Kim Seung-Jun
Suh Dong-In
Hwang Ye-Seul
Chang Jun-Hyuk
Kim Jung-Hoon
Yang Jae-Ho
Hwang Hye-Jung

Editorial Crew
Jeong Yun-Jo
Lee Chung-Hyun
Suh Yeon-Soo
Cho Seung-Hyun
Lim Chae-Won
Sung Ho-Kyung

Design Crew
Eom So-Young
Shin Jae-Yoon
Kwak Yeong-Joo
Min Pu-Reum
Kim Chai-Rin
Kim Na-Yeon
Kim Soo-Hyun
Jeong Yoon-Seung
Jeong Jin-Ho

Photography Crew
Kang Ji-Young
Ryu Jin-Gyeong
Kim Seo-Hee
Kim Jung-Hoon
Lim Seong-Min
Choi Jeong-Yeon
Lee Hye-Min

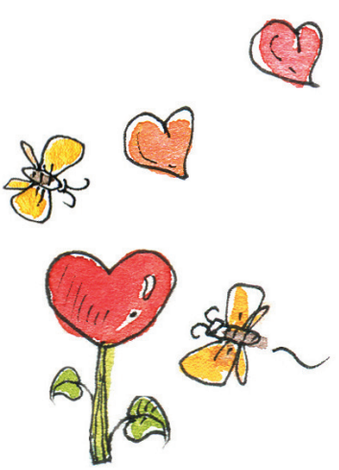
CONTACT INFORMATION
We welcome suggestions, criticisms, and contributions.
minjokheraldonline@gmail.com

Editor's Note

With our busy schedules pushing us into hectic lives,
there's little room for a real sense of serenity and freedom to find its place.
The seniors find themselves reminiscing the times
when they did not have to think of college;
the juniors are struggling with the countless responsibilities
the school throws at them;
the freshmen are just trying to keep up with the new environment.
It's hard times for all of us.

Ultimately, we all have to decide for ourselves
what constitutes our three years of the general "KMLA life,"
but I can confidently say that life here
is not a check-list of acquisitions or achievements.
In fact, it might as well be the depth and sincerity
of the relationships we form.
Maybe it is time to ask ourselves
have not we been so caught up with quizzes, papers, and clubs
that we forgot to turn our attention
to the more human aspects in our lives.
The joy of intimacy, the smiles of our friends and family,
and the proliferation of the love and care
given to you by people around you.
Connect with others. Try to understand.
Reach out a helping hand to those who need them.

One of the aims of the student press is
to provide synchronization by means of communication.
In this issue, Minjok Herald presents
the warmly human stories of healing in KMLA.
Everyone has something to say. It is our job to find, listen, and convey.
In the spirit of this issue, share your story and listen to others'.
Let all your worries melt with the last of the snow
and make room in your heart for spring to bloom.



Sincerely,
Editor-in-chief
Lee Eun-Ji

minjokherald

June 20th. 2013 | Volume 28. No.1 48th edition | Publisher Yun Chung-Il

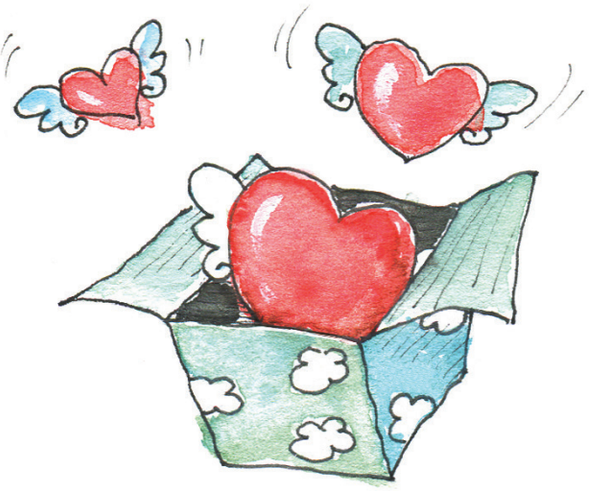


Table of Contents

04 From The Inside

Students want a more student-centered Q&A Session during elections.....4

School finally changing elevators due to students' and parents' complaints.....5

Introducing the new student radio 'Agora'.....10

11 Feature Story
A Hepling Hand in KMLA

How We KMLAians Overcome Our Freshmen Fears.....12

Starting Relationships with Teachers, Approaching Advisors.....16

Korean students under intense stress without professional care.....17

18 Intermission

KMLA Favorites: Watching and Listening.....18

22 People

Greeting the return of our old family: A talk with three returning 16th wavers.....21

25 Literary and Drawing Contest Winner

26 Editorials

School Club Fair Needs a Systematic Set of Rules and Planning for Future Success.....26

Why Enrolling in Hagwons Should Be Discouraged.....29

30 Opinion

School Club Fair Swept in dissatisfaction, Club Union Makes Amends

After the last School Club Fair in March 2nd, KMLA Forum was set ablaze by dissatisfied KMLAians. The foremost issues discussed were that the School Club Fair was held in the first floor of the Dasan Hall instead of the gym, in which previous ones were held, and that the one minute given to each club for introduction was suddenly removed.

The location of the School Club Fair caused the general atmosphere of the event to be extremely chaotic. Thus, most KMLAians had a hard time informing the 18th wavers about their clubs. What made the situation worse was the annual rap battle of *Rhyme Factory* (*RF*). Due to the fact that the *RF* booth was positioned in a corridor between the lobby of Dasan Hall and the 1st conference room, the rap battle clogged the path, and many clubs whose booths were placed in the 1st conference room were deprived of the chance to greet 18th wavers. The time constraints were also brought up. The showcase of the performing clubs took longer than the original limitation of 7 minutes per club due to various complications such as the preparation of equipment. As a result, members of the less well-known clubs, as well as non-performance clubs in general, were stripped of both of their chances to introduce themselves. Kwon Nam-Hyung, head of *Te Quiero*, says "All that we 'marginal' clubs aim for is the club introductions, since people rarely visit our booths."

Lee Yong-Kyun, head of *Wikipedia KMLA*, highlighted another problem, stating, "Only 30 minutes were allotted for the club introductions despite the fact that there were over 60 clubs that were going to participate." The fact that performing clubs already had another chance to present themselves during the Freshmen Welcoming Party was another factor that roused indignation.

Facing these problems, Kim Seung-Jun, the chief of the Club Union, posted an apology on KMLA Online, and also provided reasons for and solutions to the complications. He stated that he was informed only five days before that Welly Hilly Park would be unable to lend KMLA desks for the School Club Fair. Thus, holding the fair at Dasan Hall was an alternative he and the vice-chief Lee Chung-Hyun came up with, and future fairs would be held at the gym as before. He also suggested that performance clubs that participate in the Freshmen Welcoming Party should not perform at the School Club Fair, that the club introduction time should be separated from the fair itself, and that Club Union members ought to contact Welly Hilly Park at least a month prior to the fair. Kim wasn't alone in posting an apology, as Jung Gyu-Shik, the head of *RF*, did so as well, expressing deep regret about the actions of RF during the School Club Fair. With the apologies of Kim and Jung and the club introduction time that was provided three days hence, the issue was, at least temporarily, wrapped up. However, it is of general consensus that the school administration and the Club Union should make definite amends for the future fairs to come.

Lee Jin-Gyu
Junior Writer, 17th wave

Students Express Desire for a More Student-centered Q&A Session During Elections

Every year prior to the Student Council elections in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), a Q&A (Questions & Answers) session for candidates is held in the gym. This period of time allows both the students and the previous student council to learn more about each candidate's election promises and what changes each candidate guarantees to the school system. The questions asked also provide an opportunity to test each candidate's knowledge and degree of interest in the Student Council as well.

But this year's Q&A session seemed a bit different. As an effort to appeal to the audience and gain the audience's attention, some of the Student Council members asked witty questions that had a sense of humor but had a relative connection to the Student Council. For instance, the Judicial Branch provided its candidates with a situation where a student dramatically grunted about receiving unjustified penalty points. The audience seemed entertained by the rather humorous situation, and the Judicial Branch carefully recorded each candidate's responses to use later for their evaluation.

Yet, some students criticized the 14th Student Council for their ways of carrying out the Q&A system. "It felt like the Student Council was showing a dictatorship of the Q&A session by not leaving any room for students to question candidates. The Q&A session must be centered more towards the inquiries of students," remarks 17th waver Ko Keun-Hyeong.

"The Student Council must create an atmosphere where students can concentrate better, such as giving more opportunities for students to ask candidates. Furthermore, when asking a candidate, the Student Council should only ask questions about that candidate's campaign and not about other candidates' campaigns and written assignments," says 17th waver Lee Seok-Hwa.

A 16th waver, Yoo Jin-Sun, who prepared various questions for each candidate, stated that he was a bit disappointed because he could only ask one question to a Judicial Branch candidate during the entire Q&A session. He also said that the Q&A session should start from 6:30 P.M. instead of 7:00 to give more time for students to question candidates and make more preparations beforehand.

"I also regret the fact that there was so little time left for students to ask questions. Students definitely have different perspectives on candidates than the Student Council and should have the right to express such opinions," says Song Ho-Young of the 14th Judicial Branch. To give more time for students' inquiries, Song made suggestions such as limiting the questioning time to 20 minutes per council. Lee Ha-Jung of the 14th Legislative Branch also says, "I hope that more students take interest in each candidate's written assignment and if possible, I would suggest having a group of students who can actually take part in making the questions for the Q&A session. Such a system would be of great help towards promoting the Student Council elections to normal students and raising awareness about the election throughout the school." The Student Council continues to urge students for more enthusiasm during Q&A sessions and on KMLA online and promises to bring positive reformations for students to the current Q&A session system.

Kim Byeong-Yun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Profit from Last Year's Minjok Music Festival Used for New Projectors

Staff Writer,
Kim Sol, 16th Wave

"Now, I can use the projectors with all the lights on," says Mr. Kim Sung-Woo, the AP US Politics teacher. It has been known that most of the projectors in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) were too old and hence they could not be viewed clearly unless the lights were off. Many teachers thus had problems using them due to the fact that turning the light off to use the projectors seriously ruined the academic atmosphere. However, recently, a total of nine projectors were replaced: both in Chungmoo and Dasan Hall.

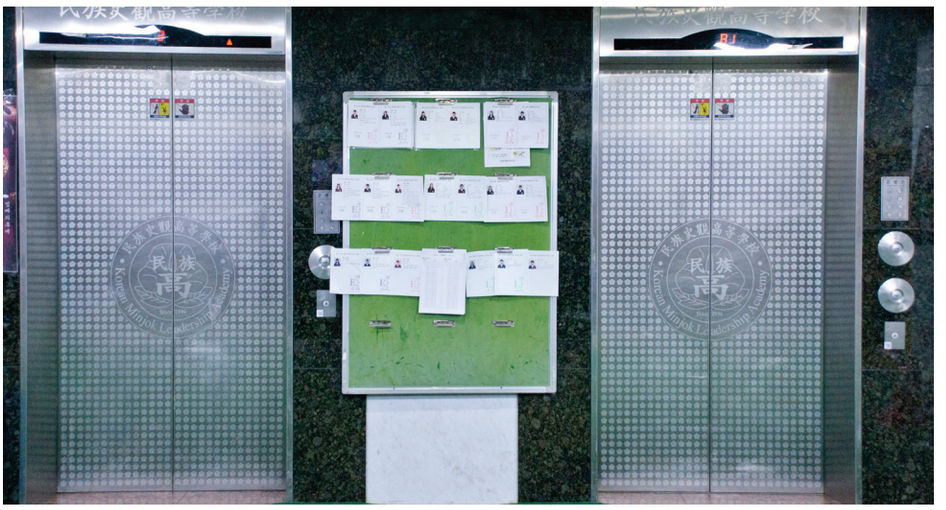
The new projectors have clearer images and are fine with the lights on. This has surely helped many teachers, as Mr. Kim added: "students used to doze more often before these new projectors." Mr. Jung Sang-Min, who teaches Korean History, has also mentioned the same thing. "Students noticeably doze less due to the lights being all on."

Then where did the money for the new projectors came from? The answer was in the 2012 Minjok Music Festival. In an interview with the Minjok Herald, the Director of the Administration Office, Mr. Choi Kyung-Jong, gave the following information. The 2012 Minjok Music Festival made a profit of 13 million won. As a response to many teachers' request for new projectors, the administration office had added 3 million won to the 13 million won, spending total 16.15 million won to purchase total nine new projectors. Mr. Choi also added that the profits from the 2011 Minjok Music Festival were kept for the construction of the new girl's dormitory.

Thanks to this use of 2012 Minjok Music Festival's profits, students can now study in a much better environment: with the lights all on, and with a clearer picture.

School Finally Renovating Elevators due to Students' and Parents' Complaints

Kim Ri-Hyun,
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

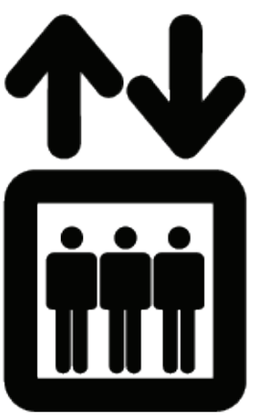


In the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) dormitory, the four elevators are an essential means of transportation that have been in place since 1999. Yet, despite their importance, they broke down several times last year, causing concern amongst students and parents. Last year in September, when one of elevators was going up to the cafeteria, it suddenly stopped at the 2nd floor, then fell down to the first basement floor. Though no one suffered from serious injuries, students who had been in the elevator were deeply frightened. 17th waver Jang Su-Min states that she was very scared though she pushed the emergency button immediately after the downfall. The incident alone frightened her enough, but she was even more scared by thinking of what could have happened if the elevator had fallen down from a higher floor.

According to the Director of the Administration Office, Mr. Choi Kyung-Jong, the school finally planned to change two of old elevators due to constant and strong complaints from parents and students. Several incidents regarding the elevator-related accidents led parents to speak out strongly on elevator safety through the parent-teacher association. However, Mr. Choi's opinion differed from those of students and parents. He states, "The misunderstanding of parents originated from the overstatement of several minor incidents that did not endanger the students in any way." However, as he is a father himself, he also commented that he understands how parents feel about the old elevators, and opted to have the elevators replaced.

The 2012 parents association decided to pay for the cost of replacing one elevator from the remainder of the parent association dues. The other elevator will be paid by the remainder of upcoming 2013 parent association dues. Mr. Choi explained that it takes about one or two weeks to select the proper design for the elevator, and about two months manufacturing the elevator. Installation of the new elevators will also take approximately one month each. Whereas each of the two main elevators now stop at odd numbered or even numbered floors only, the two new elevators will stop at all floors.

News about replacing two elevators was received with positive responses by students and parents. Most of students interviewed said that they want safety to be the number one agenda in replacing the two elevators. Some students put forward the idea that the elevator could be made larger to accommodate more students. Also, they want the elevator to be more advanced in design, so that they can unselect the floors that they selected by mistake. The new elevators come after much persuasion on behalf of students and parents; as such, everyone hopes that the construction will be managed with safety and without conflict.



Bigger Size Classes This Semester Show Drawbacks

A small classroom full of students, some sitting on tiny chairs with little space to put one's book and notes to write on - this is what we can easily see during some of the Korean, math, and English classes that 17th wavers are taking this year. Due to changes in the criteria of dividing students into classes and the number of students who chose the humanities and the sciences track, the unbalance in the number of students in each class is emerging as a problem. The biggest change from last year is dividing international students based on the math course they chose as they were required to choose between Calculus and Calculus BC when signing up for classes in December.

"It seems like math teachers decided to divide international students into two groups since there were some students who had difficulty following the math class. Accordingly, they made an easier course named Calculus to enhance students' performance," said Mr. Park Yong-Sung, the Manager of the Office of Curriculum Management when asked about this class division.

"This change is not intended to divide international students into humanities or science like we do in the domestic field. Still, we accepted the decision of the math teachers and divided the class accordingly. Thus, it was inevitable for the class with students who chose Calculus to be bigger than other ones since dividing them into more classes will make classes with only 9 or 10 students, which is too small for an effective class to be carried out."

As such, this change was made for the benefit of students in the international field. They were able to choose what level of math most suited them. However, because of this change, one negative consequence was the increased size of the classes. In the 16th waver's case last year, both Calculus and Calculus BC were divided into two classes, but for the 17th wavers, all students who chose Calculus is part of one class while those who chose Calculus BC was divided into two. Hence, as opposed to the small 13 or 14 students in one class last year, people taking Calculus now have 19 students, an increase of about 50%. Although 19 may not seem like a big number, the students nevertheless feel dissatisfied due to the dramatic increase compared to the small classes they enjoyed last year. Also, because the students have to take all the classes except electives with their class of 19 students, other classes, such as English Composition, Korean, and Korean History, have to be crowded as well.

According to Mr. Park, such crowding in some classes and sparse students in others has been always a dilemma for teachers.

And when some classes have disproportionately high numbers of students, the students are left to deal with the drawbacks. The most common dissatisfaction among students was the lack of space for everyone in classrooms. KMLA used to be well known for its small size classes, so it is normal for most of the classes to only have seats for about 17 students at most. Having a classroom packed with students feels stuffed enough; when extra seats are brought in to accommodate even more students, both teachers and students suffer. Aside from the lack of space, students also speak of not having enough time for discussion. As it is common in our school to have classes with debates and discussions - especially, international students - students are having hard time engaging in the discussions due to too many students in one class. Unruly classes are also a problem. As a natural consequence of bigger classes, more students are dozing or talking during classes. Getting those students to concentrate again means little time left for the teacher, thus making it hard for them to give out individual comments which are important for students' improvement.

The crowding of students in certain classes has always surfaced as a problem in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, yet is generally considered as an irresolvable problem - the students are given the freedom to choose their classes, but with this freedom come consequences. However, although this problem was usually limited to certain elective classes, this semester, some students have to face this problem in their required classes as well. To ensure the quality of classes, it seems like the students themselves should strive to create a studious environment.

Kim Ji-Ho
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

Welcoming a New Manager in the Office of College Counseling

Students have no reason to worry, OCC says

The students in the International Program (IP), who constitute nearly half of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) student body, are currently in confusion. This is because the former manager of College Counseling, Ms. Lee Sun-Jin, left the school on short notice. As Mr. Chung Key-One takes over the position, students are voicing their anxieties on the potential impact of such abrupt changes. Minjok Herald, on behalf of the students and with considerate help from the teachers, inquired into some of the most frequently asked questions: Has this kind of change ever happened before? How well-equipped is the school to deal with such shifts? How should the students respond to the issue?

To gain answers to these questions, Minjok Herald interviewed the related members in the Office of College Counseling (OCC) and the representative advisor of the 12th grade. Remarkably, all the interviewed teachers emphasized that ultimately, students themselves are the most important part of the application process. As Mr. Chung says, the responsibility of college counselor lies in presenting to colleges the talents that all students have in an effective manner; the actualization of such gifts, as seen through academics, extracurricular activities, and essays, is entirely up to the student. Moreover, he emphasized that college can never be an ultimate goal, and that students must work to maximize their potential no matter where they are.

However, let alone the change itself, the suddenness of the change seems to be what worries many international students. Park Min-Jung, a 16th waver in the IP, says that being informed during the winter break of such change was not a pleasant situation to handle. For one thing, as Mr. Chung took over as counselor, many seniors who planned to ask him for recommendation letters are left to find a different teacher. However, such changes are not unprecedented. "KMLA has had three replacements in the position of manager of OCC, including the one at hand. For parents, who are understandably sensitive about college related issues, the current changes would be felt keenly. However, having experienced such shifts in the past, KMLA has always been prepared, with a teacher to succeed the professional position in case of sudden vacancy," says Mr. Cheon Soo-In, the representative advisor of the 12th grade. In addition, the OCC has many other experienced members who will aid Mr. Chung in his adjustment to the new post. Mr. Wayne Baumgardner will act as support to Mr. Chung in building relationships with admissions officers overseas; the advisors of the IP seniors, Mr. Cheon as the representative advisor, will also assist the new manager. Mr. Baumgardner told Minjok Herald that "there will be no major changes because the systems in place at KMLA work and there is no need to revamp or overhaul anything." There are clear systems in practice, and the mechanism is stabilizing as the semester commences and the counseling is beginning to take place.

KMLA certainly has its worries about the OCC and the general college application. However, a house divided cannot stand. The OCC looks to the students to keep to the basics—work hard and aim high like we always did.

Staff Writer,
Lee Hye-Joon, 16th Wave
Junior Writer,
Park So-Hyeon, 17th Wave

Common Application Undergoes Significant Change, but Will Not Greatly Effect Students

The two main changes in the Common App this year has been the deletion of the short extracurricular responses and the change in the main essay prompts. Furthermore, these main essays are now strictly limited to 650 words. There is also a chance that students will no longer be able to include a resume with their Common App; however, students may still be able to do so with the supplementary applications. The change in the Common App applies to both United States and international students; therefore, all students applying for college this year will be on equal footing. In essence, the change will not necessarily hurt anyone's in particular.

Mr. Wayne Baumgardner, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) teacher and college counselor, believes that the word limit is appropriate since most essays in the past rarely went past 650 words anyways. Regarding the change in the essay prompts, Mr. Baumgardner says that the main concern for college counselors has been the removal of the former Topic #6: "Topic of your choice." Common App has responded to this concern by saying that their new Topic #1 ("Some students have a background or story that is so central to their identity that they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story") replaces the old Topic #6. The OCC "also feels the new prompt takes on the spirit of the topic of your choice prompt it is replacing."

Mr. Baumgardner also highly encourages all students to visit Ms. Lee Ye-Hui's office (Dasan 101) to review past Common and Supplementary applications of KMLA students. He said that "The college essay is very important for admissions officers in gaining some insight into who the student is as a person…As students read through the college essays, they should ask themselves what they are learning about the person who wrote the essay."

Chung Yoo-Jin
Staff Writer, 16th Wave

Change in School Uniform Color

Loss of Tradition or Step Towards Improvement?

At the beginning of the second semester last year, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA)'s Legislative Branch collected student opinion on how to improve the school uniforms for future waves. Through KMLA Online, many students suggested changes to the colors of the school uniforms to match *hanboks* designed and manufactured by SMART, the brand that supplied the hanboks for some waves before the 13th wave. Others pointed out that the winter formal *hanbok* was too heavy without being very warm and some complained about the scratchy material of the summer formal *hanbok*. Thus, the Executive Branch took action and met with Ludia Hanbok, the brand that currently supplies KMLA uniforms, to discuss possible improvements.

When the new school year started in February, the 16th and the 17th wavers could see clear differences between their school uniforms and those of the 18th wavers. For one, the outer fabric of the winter formal *hanbok* of the 18th wavers is very similar to the outer fabric of the summer formal *hanbok* of the 16th and 17th wavers, meaning that the winter formal *hanbok* became lighter and more convenient for activities. Also, the texture of the outer fabric of the new winter casual *hanboks* became similar to the 16th and 17th wavers' fall casual *hanboks*. However, perhaps the most noticeable change was the color of the school uniforms.

The three colors of the 18th wavers' casual *hanboks* were light-green, light-red (close to orange) and light-grey. The light-green *hanbok* can be thought of as a brighter version of the 16th wavers' green winter casual *hanboks* and the light-red color is similar to the red summer casual *hanboks* of the 17th wavers, but with a touch of orange in it. The light-grey color however, seems to be a brand-new color that was first introduced with the 18th wavers by Ludia Hanbok.

But many former KMLA students seemed disappointed by Ludia Hanbok's efforts to utilize SMART Hanbok's colors. "The green uniform looks like a fluorescent colored Post-It," says 17th waver Kim Chai-Rin. Due to the strange colors, many students criticized the fact that uniforms seemed too distant from Korean tradition. "It looks bad because it doesn't bring out the traditional beauty of the *hanbok*," says 17th waver Park So-Hyeon.

Nonetheless, the 18th wavers seem to have positive opinions regarding their own uniforms. 18th waver Ryu Hyun-Seung states, "The uniforms are great since they reflect our energy and liveliness." 18th waver Lee Sun-Ha also remarks, "I feel better about the uniforms after wearing them for a month. When I first saw the colors, none of them looked very pretty, but now they look much better."

"The main reason for the school choosing Ludia Hanbok was because of its efforts to lower the unit cost of the uniforms," said Kim Zi-On of the Executive Branch. "Furthermore, KMLA is the only school which uses the *hanbok* as its official school uniform, so the school doesn't have a lot of choices when it comes to choosing manufacturers that can produce large amounts of *hanbok*."

From the early years of KMLA, the *hanbok* has been an essential part of the school's identity. It was and is still a unique part of KMLA that endows students with Korean pride and tradition. But with changes being made to the *hanboks* each year, KMLAians should be mindful about whether these changes are for or against the betterment of *hanboks* fulfilling their true purpose of displaying genuine Korean beauty and tradition.

Kim Byeong-Yun
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

New Student Radio "Agora" Off to a Great Start

On the February of 2013, a new student radio called "Agora" was founded. The three co-founders, 16th wave Kim Hong-Soon, Lee Joon-Suk, and Choi Hyun-Min have already released their first program which features 16th wave Park Se-In. They plan to release each program once in two weeks, hosting different guests for each program.

Agora is in fact, not the first student radio in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA). There was already a radio founded by the 13th wave. 13th wavers Kim Tae-Yeob and Park Jun-Sub founded several radio programs for student entertainment such as "*Jji-bam*" or "*Sib-Ra*". However, these radios disappeared as the 13th wave graduated from KMLA. To continue the legacy, 14th waver Bae Gwang-Bin made an effort to revive the radio culture by founding a radio called "KMLADIO". Despite its success of the first program, it soon disappeared due to personal reasons. After that, there were some plans to make a new radio in the 15th wave, which unfortunately did not lead to a success. This was when 16th wavers Kim Hong-Soon, Lee Joon-Suk, and Park Se-In first planned to found a new radio. Later on, 16th wave Park Se-In was replaced with Choi Hyun-Min and the Agora was born.

According to the three DJs of Agora, the purpose of Agora is mainly for entertainment. "I was deeply impressed when I listened to the first program of "KMLADIO" and that's why I decided to make one myself" said Kim Hong-Soon, in an interview with Minjok Herald. He also mentioned that Agora was intended to appeal to a wider range of people, disregarding gender or age. Such is why the three DJs will try to work out on universal humors and gags. Hong-Soon said in his final remark that the members of Agora will do their best to release new programs on a weekly basis in order to avoid the irresponsible precedents.

The first program that was released on the 16th of February was a huge success. Within a few minutes, all of the downloading servers were shut down due to excessive amounts of download requests. A vast majority of the students who listened to the radio showed positive reactions towards the first program. "It was really funny. Maybe it was because the guest was Se-In, but anyways, I laughed so much" said 16th waver Hwang Sung-Jae, reflecting the immense amount of popularity among the students. With such great success from the start, Agora seems to have a very promising future.

Staff Writer
Suh Dong-In, 16th Wave

Dispute between the Student Council and the Department of Audit Inspection Delay Results

The latest Student Council midterm audit results belatedly came out in February. The results, in theory, were, supposed to be announced in the middle of the last term, so that the Student Council could take them into account for the rest of the term.

The Department of Audit Inspection (DAI) is a relatively new department, as it replaced the Department of Social Service (DSS) as of last year. The job of the DAI is to formulate surveys regarding the performance of the student council, hand them out among students, and collect the data to present a final result. During the first year of the DAI has undertaken two audits, one each for the 13th and 14th Student Councils, and is currently planning to audit other departments as well.

The problem at hand is the delay of the outcome of the audit results. This was caused by a conflict between the Student Council and the DAI last November, as explained in an apology written by Lee Chung-Hyun, the head of the executive branch, posted on KMLA Online (No. 93020). In the apology, it is stated that the student council believed that some of the questions posed, such as "What does the duty as a member of the student council mean to you?", and "Do you enjoy your duty?" were irrelevant. However, the DAI believed that this was an infringement of its rights and denied the Student Council's request to reconsider the questions. The Student Council then decided to call Kim Kyung-Yoon, the head of the DAI at that time, to a meeting to decide what to do with the surveys. Kim did accept the suggestion, but interpreted this request as yet another instance of malfeasance. In the end, the participants concluded that a guideline for audit questions was necessary, that the students should decide whether the questions should be changed, and that the intervention of the Student Council was uncalled for. "As this was only the second audit held by the DAI, inexperience did contribute to the delay," added Kim. Thus, this dispute, caused by the differing views of the Student Council and the DAI concerning the nature of the audit, and the additional time taken delayed the announcement of the audit results.

When interviewed about his sentiment about the delay, Song Ho-Young, the chief of the 14th Judicial Branch, replied "I didn't feel much inconvenience as the head of the Judicial Branch, as the term was hectic and short enough to prevent a lame-duck period. However, as a KMLAian, I regret the interference of the Student Council in the affairs of the DAI, as the Student Council pressured the department by privately expressing disapproval of its efforts." Lee Ha-Jung stated "I, as the head of the Legislative Branch, feel much responsibility regarding the delay. With the excuse of granting autonomy to the DAI, the Legislative Branch sat on its hands without aiding the process of the audit, and even started a clash for which I would like to apologize as a member of the Student Council. In the wake of this complication, the 14th student council is trying to prevent this problem from reoccurring by establishing the role of the DIA and the purpose of the audit." and also beseeched KMLAians to look up the audit results. Lee Chung-Hyun, the chief of the Executive Branch said "It would have been much preferable if the audit results had come out earlier, for then the Student Council members could have improved on matters that were unsatisfactory to KMLAians. I was also sorry that KMLAians were only informed of the council members' attitude concerning our duties, as the general view and understanding of the student council may have changed with that knowledge." In addition, 17th waver Kim Ja-Eun, provided a positive perspective, saying "The fact that the 18th wavers could take a look at the audit results was beneficial."

Since the duty of audit management was given to a nascent department and caused confusion among DIA and student council members, a period of transition occurred. Though a conflict between the DIA and the student council delayed the compilation of audit results, the heads of both parties have shown much responsibility about the issue. As the DIA and the Student Council are willing to cooperate, KMLAians can hope that the midterm audits, which are integral components of student autonomy, will soon take root in KMLA.

Lee Jin-Gyu
Junior Writer, 17th Wave

When I have Fears that I may cease to be

John Keats

WHEN I have fears that I may cease to be
Before my pen has glean'd my teeming brain,
Before high pil`d books, in charact'ry,
Hold like rich garners the full-ripen'd grain;
When I behold, upon the night's starr'd face,
Huge cloudy symbols of a high romance,
And feel that I may never live to trace
Their shadows, with the magic hand of chance;
And when I feel, fair creature of an hour!
That I shall never look upon thee more,
Never have relish in the faery power
Of unreflecting love;—then on the shore
Of the wide world I stand alone, and think,
Till Love and Fame to nothingness do sink.

A Helping Hand in KMLA

a healing special

When fear of starting a new year devastates us,
when we are being dragged by the immediate tasks at hand,
when we are dejected by the results of our exams,
we need a helping hand to comfort us and lead us
to the next step we can take.
Ironically, KMLA has been the primary source of our stress,
but at the same time,
the home-like destination we eventually rest in:
Sok-Sak-Im, the manito system, counseling classes,
and sincere pieces of advice from teachers
all soothe our torn hearts and clear up our blurry future.
After all, the school is not only a place to grow academically,
but also a place to mature from inside.
Our feature crew, greatly concerned with such a role of the school,
raised some critical questions regarding numerous ways
the school serves as a "helping hand" to the student body.
In the very first edition for the year 2013,
we have offered some insights into
how each wave can lead
a more productive and emotionally stable life in KMLA.
Enjoy!

How We KMLAians Overcome Our FRESHMAN FEARS

KMLA starts off this year with 153 new members, the 18th wave. As amazing as KMLA is, it is also a very difficult place to adapt to, and every student is prone to the freshmen fears. Annually, about three or four people in the freshmen wave either transfer to another school or take some time off of school. This may not seem to be such a big issue, but for a small populated, elite school that is difficult to get in, the fact that some people would actually try to leave school is astonishing. This article provides an analysis of a survey, conducted towards 17th and 18th wavers about their freshmen fears, and various methods to overcome such fears.

So, why is it so hard to survive in KMLA? According to a survey conducted by Minjok Herald in March, the start of the semester, the 18th wave students are mainly concerned about two major issues. First of all, they are worried about their future lives, both inside and outside of KMLA. Approximately 91 of the 18th wave respondents answered that they are worried about their future grades and career. After entering KMLA by overcoming many obstacles such as the application letter and the interview, it has struck the 18th wavers that the more serious problems actually lie ahead of them. In other words, they are now obligated to compete against the 153 students who are as capable as everyone else. Not only are the 18th wavers worried about their grades, but they are also worried about the new features of KMLA as well. More than 90 students also answered that too much new information and regulation are stressful, such as entrance interviews for clubs, waking up at 6 AM, and managing penalty points. The sheer amount of such regulations and information causes an enormous amount of stress for the 18th wave students.

Nonetheless, according to the survey, about 80% of the students in KMLA overcame their freshman fears in the course of 1 year. In other words, after a significant amount of time, there is a high probability that these kinds of stress are more likely to fade away. According to the 17th wave respondents, who also chose the same reasons for the major source of stress in their freshmen years, the best way to relieve freshmen stress was to talk it out with their roommates. The 2nd best response was surprising, because most of the 17th wavers chose the last option; "others", and wrote similar answers for it. All of the respondents who answered "others" said that they actually haven't overcome their fear of KMLA 100%.

Freshmen year is a very stressful season for many. Nobody in KMLA would say that they survived the year without going through any sort of freshmen fears. However, as 17th waver Jung Jinho says, "There is no specific way to reduce the amount of stress that one has to undergo. It is only you, as a student, who has to overcome those fears by changing your perspective towards the school and sharing your ideas with your roommate."

Kim Jung-Hoon
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Counseling Classes From A to Z

Counseling Classes, How it Differs Among Grades

In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA), students are required to take counseling classes an hour per week every semester. However, because what students need to focus on each grade is different, counseling classes vary among grades.

Freshmen's counseling classes usually concentrate on problems related to the school life. Considering the fact that KMLA is a dormitory school, the school figured out that counseling on school or dormitory problems would be appropriate for freshmen. On top of that, students draw out their future careers and research colleges. Once every month, students have a counseling class focused on college admission. They learn about the successful cases of university admission and those candidates' accurate resumes. In fact, a freshman counseling period offers a great opportunity for the new faces to break the ice and to better get to know each other through individual speech sections and presentations on each one's background. Contrary to such an opinion, 17th waver Kim Tae-Wook said that counseling class was quite a difficult time for him because it was awkward to tell his worries in front of classmates that he just met. For the past few years, freshmen's counseling classes were progressed by Ms. Park Hye-Sun, but she was not able to continue her counseling classes from last year's second semester. As a result, counseling classes were mostly self-study time during the second semester and some displayed complains about such measures of the school.

Starting from 2013, new teachers are in charge of counseling classes. For freshmen, Ms. Kim Yeo-Ram took the baton. She plans to progress activities such as making a time schedule, getting mid-term examination advice from seniors, etc. Mr. Kang Mun-Geun(for domestic field) and Mr. Jung Ki-Won(for international field) will take care of the counseling classes every fourth week, concentrating on college admission.

Counseling classes of sophomores greatly differ from those of freshmen. A noticeable difference is that classes are divided into two: domestic field and international field counseling. The domestic field counseling class is composed of the teacher's lectures on an analysis of graduates' cases and what students have to prepare for college admission. Especially, starting from sophomores, students take turns to get individual counseling from the teacher. While individual counseling is done, the rest self-study during the period. 16th waver Suh Dong-In said that such counseling classes were helpful, enabling him to arrange his thoughts and information and get a better view of his situation and what he has to focus on. In contrast, 16th waver Choi Ye-Rin stated that an individual counseling took less than expected. International field counseling classes are mostly composed of skype sessions with alumni. In conversations with alumni, students are able to ask questions about particular colleges or college admissions. However, because most of the classes were skype sessions, some students found it repetitive and inefficient.

Perhaps counseling classes are most important for seniors because it is their last year before entering college. All ten classes take counseling classes separately, letting students get counseling in a much smaller group of people. Starting with domestic field counseling, students write peer-letters. Every class, one or two students go to the front and introduce themselves (their childhood, family, future career, etc.). Then, the selected peer will write a recommendation letter for the student. This way, students can know about each other well and take advice from classmates and the teacher. For the international field, Mr. Chung Key-Won gives general information on universities, recommendation letters, cover letters, and so on. Some international field students wish to learn some tips for writing their admission essays. Both domestic and international field students take turns getting individual counseling with the teacher. Through individual counseling, students are able to get a better view of what they need to work on.

Counseling classes are sometimes a big stress. However, it is a student's job to absorb the information from counseling classes and wisely use them. Through counseling classes from freshmen to seniors, students will be able to identify what they are good at, what they have passion for, and what they want to be. By this process, students will one day find themselves being in a position they have always dreamed of.

Hwang Ye-Seul
Staff Feature Writer, 16th Wave

Hey, Come to the Cafeteria!

Cafeteria counseling brings forth positive changes to school

This kind of conversation is pretty commonplace in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) regardless of the time being. After honjeong, you can easily witness several groups of people in the cafeteria, ready to immerse themselves to the so called, "healing" process. This caring and warmhearted cafeteria counseling has almost become some kind of a tradition or ritual for KMLAians.

Why is this phenomenon so prevalent in KMLA? It's partly because the school is located in the middle of nowhere where squirrels and grasses are the only companions nearby. It's also because of the uniqueness of KMLA life: the fact that we spend three years of high school in the same dormitory, self-study hall, cafeteria and classroom. Thus, we know each other best. Then, why do students prefer cafeteria for counseling over other places? Self-study hall is only a place for studying and dormitory rooms are restrictive in the sense that only the same genders can give counseling to each other. Instead, the cafeteria is open to anyone, regardless of gender or what grade you are in. Besides, the toaster and cereal in the cafeteria create a comfortable atmosphere for the students, having a bite of nutellla-plastered toast and relaxing with his or her peers.

More interestingly, the topic of counseling is not just limited to issues about grades or future career. Rather, it's more idiosyncratic than most people might imagine. Some students receive tips on how to express affection to those they like, while others share pleasant conversations about possible plans for their charity street performance. "Many boys visit my dorm room to get consolation about their heart-aching love story," Lee Hyun-Seok said. This wide range of counseling topics is maybe one of the reasons why cafeteria counseling appeals to so many students compared to professional counseling provided by therapists that might seem too formal.

Of course, the only concern is that some students devote so much time in this healing culture that sometimes they have to sacrifice their self-study considerably. Still, it is apparent that cafeteria counseling is driving KMLA towards a more cooperative, caring, and vibrant direction. On top of that, KMLA students are capable enough to manage their time well and therefore the issue of indulgence doesn't seem to pose much of a problem. Let us just hope that this culture is further reinforced over time and contribute more to spreading smiles all over KMLA.

Kim Seung-Jun
Staff Feature Writer, 16th wave

Sok-Sak-Im and the Problems it Faces

Sok-Sak-Im is a student counseling club for which the primary objective is to counsel students that have difficulties in school life. It was formed 13 years ago since the first few years of KMLA. The club is mainly organized by the student members, along with the care and management by the Chief Consultant teacher. Currently, there are seven 16th and 17th wavers who are members of Sok-Sak-Im and Mr. Ahn Sang-Joon is the teacher in charge.

There are mainly three things that Sok-Sak-Im is in charge of. First, it serves its primary purpose of counseling fellow students. The members of the club are always willing to listen to the student's hardships and provide possible solutions to their problems. Sok-Sak-Im is also responsible for the student matching procedures. Every semester, freshmen, juniors, and seniors are all paired up one by one. This is to help freshmen and juniors prepare for their new year by getting advice and help from their seniors. Thus, when pairing the students into groups, personal interests are fully considered through gathering information about the students and pairing them based on their commonalities. Lastly, Sok-Sak-Im is in charge of giving away candies along with notes that contain wise sayings during exam periods. This is a custom one will only see in KMLA.

However, Sok-Sak-Im is facing many problems. Not as many students actually ask for counseling to its members and in fact, the number is on a decreasing trend. With such trends continuing, the club is finding a hard time trying to fulfill one of its primary objectives. 16th waver Park Jong-Min, vice-chief of Sok-Sak-Im expressed his opinions on this issue in an interview with Minjok Herald. "I think the biggest reason is that students have some doubts about the club since it is only a student club, not a counseling specialized organization" said Park in his interview. He also brought up the fact that many students find it uncomfortable telling their secrets and sensitive matters to their fellow "competitors". Sok-Sak-Im does provide senior-junior counseling sessions at the start of the semester, but many students do not seem to maintain this counseling relationship, perhaps due to difficulty in approaching seniors. Thus, he suggested that activations of counseling between seniors and juniors as well as counseling within the same wave could be a probable solution to this problem.

Suh Dong-In
Staff Feature Writer, 16th wave

Manito Activities at KMLA

Responsible Manitos provides Comfort for Students

The word "manito," which came from the Italian word meaning "secret friend," has an interesting origin: According to a Greek myth, Manito was a god who was responsible for managing the time of humans. He loved humans so much that he used to stop time to save those in danger. Today, manitos, just like the Greek god, are people who secretly help their manitees. In KMLA, students have their own manitos. These secret friends give them food and presents, text messages and chats, and sometimes even encouraging letters.

What traits make the manito activities appealing to KMLA students? "First of all, there is the feeling of expectancy when choosing your manitee. You would feel satisfaction when you choose a person who you wanted." replied 17th waver Choi Jee-Woong. "Also, it is rewarding to read your manito's thank-you posts on Facebook," added Choi. "When my manitee feels happy thanks to my present, so do I." That is not all; the act of giving presents can also be satisfying by itself to the manito. "For example, when I want to repay my manitee for something she did for me before, I would give her a manito present. Then, I would feel happy."

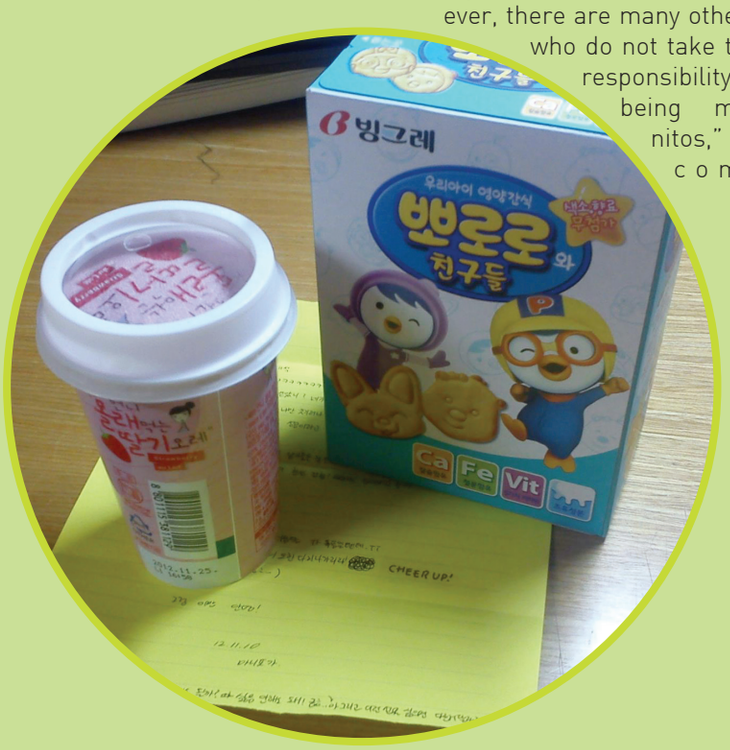
According to 17th waver Je Dong-Il, there are many cases of great manitos and their happy manitees. "Besides sending chat messages to their manitees and giving material presents, there are manitos that go beyond," he stated. "There was one manito that had a manitee who had a teacher that gave difficult math quizzes. He gave her solutions for difficult math problems." Je even mentioned a manito who gave his manitee his sister's make-up as a present.

The issue at hand is: can the manito activities provide comfort for KMLA students? "KMLA is a school that places a lot of stress on its students," said 17th waver Ro Seung-Yeon. Indeed, there are many causes of stress at KMLA, from an overabundance of homework in some courses to the harsh results of quizzes and exams. Ro stated that the manito activities can help students feel more comforted. "Receiving presents from their manitos can help students feel less stressed and find joy in those daily sectors of our lives," she said.

Unfortunately, there is a dark side to the manito activities. "There are manitos who care very much about their manitees – manitos who spend a lot of money for their manitees. However, there are many others who do not take the responsibility of being manitos," Ro commented. 17th waver Lee Dong-Hoon expressed a similar opinion. "For me, the manito activities are fine. However, this isn't true for everyone," answered Lee when questioned about how well students are carrying out the manito activities. "When students do not receive presents from their manitos, they feel a little sense of incompatibility," he added.

Manito activities can be a great help in KMLA where it is not just important but necessary for students to learn to cooperate with each other and help one another to pull through stressful situations. They can provide a psychological comfort to the students, helping them relieve their stress. Unfortunately, some students do not recognize this, being neglectful in their manito activities. On the bright side, many students are commendable manitos, actively taking responsibility for their manitees. We, as KMLA students, should keep in mind that one act of kindness can be a sunshine on a cloudy day to another.

Chang Jun-Hyuk
Feature Writer, 17th Wave



Professional Psychologists in Korean Schools

Korean students under intense stress without professional care

Korean students are under immense stress. Elementary school students are under pressure to enter a prestigious private school. Middle school students strive to enter famous prep-schools. High school students go through one of the most stressful moments of their life; they compete to enter universities. Parents don't hesitate to send their kids to private academies in order to survive through the fierce competition of school entrance at any level. As a result, many students are stressed out. Some go as far as committing suicide due to intense stress of academic pressure. However, the reality is that there are no professional counselors in the schools when solving these kinds of problems. Our school, KMLA is not an exception to the reality.

In more developed countries such as the United States and Europe, student counseling system is very well developed.

The United States

According to State School Counseling Mandates and Legislation posted in the site of the American School Counselor Association, 26 states made it mandatory to have professional counselors who have a master's degree on school psychology from grades K through 12. For every 300 students, there must be at least one counselor for these 26 states. The rest of the states mandate professional counselors from grades 9 to 12.

Norway

According to the site euroguidance, a European network of information centers for guidance systems, all schools of Norway is regulated by the government regarding the professional counselors. Referring to the 'right of guidance' mentioned in the educational regulations of Norway, the government made it mandatory for all students to have access to public counseling service within the schools.

Japan

In Professor Darryl Takizo Yagi's scholarly article, 'Current Developments in School Counseling in Japan', all elementary schools and most middle and high schools have school counselors. Japanese school counselors, who are licensed as clinical psychologists, must undergo professional development and earn enough credits to continue as school counselors for the next five-year cycle.

As we can see, countries such as the U.S., Norway, and Japan have well organized counseling systems that is regulated by their own government. However, the reality in Korea is very different. In a situation where only around 50% of the schools have 'counselors' who aren't even professional in the area of psychology, the Korean government decided to fire over 1000 counselors due to a lack of budget, according to the education department of Jeolla province.

In KMLA, there is a counseling system. There are teachers who always welcome us to talk to them personally. The head counselor, Mr. Ahn Sang-Jun said that there are over 20 students who find him for private talks. Mr. Ahn believes that the current counseling system is quite effective since the teachers can maximize the bond of sympathy with the students. He agrees that professional counselors can be effective, but doubts that they can create the bilateral link with the students. While the head counselor of KMLA thinks this way, some KMLA students seem to think differently.

17th wave Oh Ye-Jin said "I don't think that there are 'professional' counselors in KMLA. Are there any? I've never heard of a professional counselor except for university entrance counselors for both Domestic and International students. I usually don't visit teachers because I often feel uncomfortable when talking about such personal problems to a teacher. I wish that there was a professional counselor whose job is not to teach the KMLA students, but to help us out through the 3 years in KMLA." She believes that it is difficult to approach teachers who are very important in terms of university of entrance with personal matters.

17th wave Yoon Min-Jung also adds that the 'counselors' in KMLA do not know exactly how to approach the students when dealing with personal matters. Since our teachers are not professional psychologists, they carry professional knowledge about counseling itself. As a result, counseling with the KMLA teachers often turn out to be inefficient.

Many interviewed students said similar things. All three of them thought that there is a lack of 'professionalism' in the current counseling system of KMLA. Our school, although equipped with lots to relieve stress with, is also a major source of stress. Scores and rankings, and problems with relationships within school all contribute to the immense stress a typical KMLAian gets. But, there is no one whom we can talk to with our hearts opened.

The seriousness of this issue may not be completely realized until we actually take a look at the statistics. According to the World Health Organization, while Korea is at the top of the list for student suicides, Norway is ranked at 91st, and the U.S. at 34th. For murders committed by youth, Korea is ranked at 17th, while Norway is ranked at 73rd. Although 'counseling system' of schools is not to be accused for these social problems, it is certain that efforts to maintain psychological stability within teenagers in schools are paying off in countries such as Norway.

Without professional psychologists and counselors in schools, Korean students lack a systematic means to find help and relief. Even in our school KMLA, an improved form of counseling system is needed in order to encourage students to talk to the teachers. Especially in a school with such a stressful and competitive environment, perhaps a better form of 'professional' counseling is needed.

Yang Jae-Ho
Feature Writer, 17th wave

Laying the Foundation of School Life and Beyond

Starting Relationships with Teachers, Approaching Advisors

KMLAians often refer to the act of intensely developing relationships with others as 'building a tower'. This humorous and sarcastic comment is, in fact, from jealousy; it is a proof of how much people want to but experience difficulties in associating with others that they want to become closer to. Especially, students often may feel that a barrier exists between them and teachers. However, KMLA Family is a slogan that embraces all waves and even teachers. We should attempt to 'build one's tower' not only to peers, but also to teachers. To aid novice tower builders, Minjok Herald offers tips on approaching a teacher, along with gracious advices from a teacher and a graduating 15th waver seniors.

Ms. Jung Sun-Hee, the French teacher, expressed her thought that the relationship would follow if students would be less cautious in opening up and actively engage in academic classes.

"Nowadays, more students seem to have become comfortable in letting others into their worlds," she said, "but the vast majority still passively waits for someone else to come up to them first. The teacher cannot reach all of his or her students because of limited time. One doesn't have to consciously strive to make an impression on a teacher, but participating actively in class certainly helps."

She also gave a Decalogue on how to become a memorable student, as the following:

1. Change for the better.
2. Acknowledge your friends' and your own achievements and strengths
3. Understand your weak points and strive to overcome them.
4. Cheer for yourself and your friends.
5. Bear a dream.
6. Make a choice based on what you can enjoy, not from judging outcomes and difficulty
7. Recognize mistakes and pay for them.
8. Do not lie, or confess your lie if you ever should.
9. Think that rules are there not 'just to avoid getting caught' but 'must be kept.'
10. Always think of 'together.'

Myeong Do-Hyeong, a graduating 15th waver, urged KMLA students not to be intimidated by teachers:

"KMLA Family certainly extends to students; actually, the bond between you and your teachers can be stronger than that between you and your family. Teachers treat you as a complete individual, and can help you tackle convoluted problems that seem to be inappropriate to talk with both friends and the family."

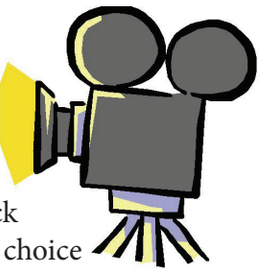
She added tips on consulting a teacher: ask a teacher whom you are familiar with or has similar values as yours (or else, each side might feel awkward and uncomfortable), remember to be polite when asking for advice, and always thank the teacher at the end of your conversation.

The 'tower' that we form during our years in KMLA is priceless. It is what propels us up to another stage of life, not only in school but also beyond. Not just for our recommendation letters, not just for academic purposes. Another perspicacious quote from Myeong Do-Hyeong:

"Personally, I was not a student who was extremely close to teachers. But now as I reflect on my school years, I regret not having associated with teachers more. Teachers do not bite you. Just go up to them and say something: a topic that came up in class that interests you, a book you are reading right now, something the teacher might enjoy talking about – anything. You won't regret it."

Hwang Hye-Jung
Feature Writer, 17th Wave

KMLA Favorites
What do YOU Watch?



KMLA is located in the middle of mountains, and it takes at least one and a half hour back and forth to go out to Won-ju, the nearest city. This means that students usually have no choice but to stay in school during their free time. One most common way students spend their free time at school is to watch movies. But sometimes, especially when with friends, it takes tremendously long time to choose what movie to watch. Minjok Herald proposes a few movies, in hope that the list might help students shorten the time that they might waste finding proper movies and thus enjoy their free time more fully.

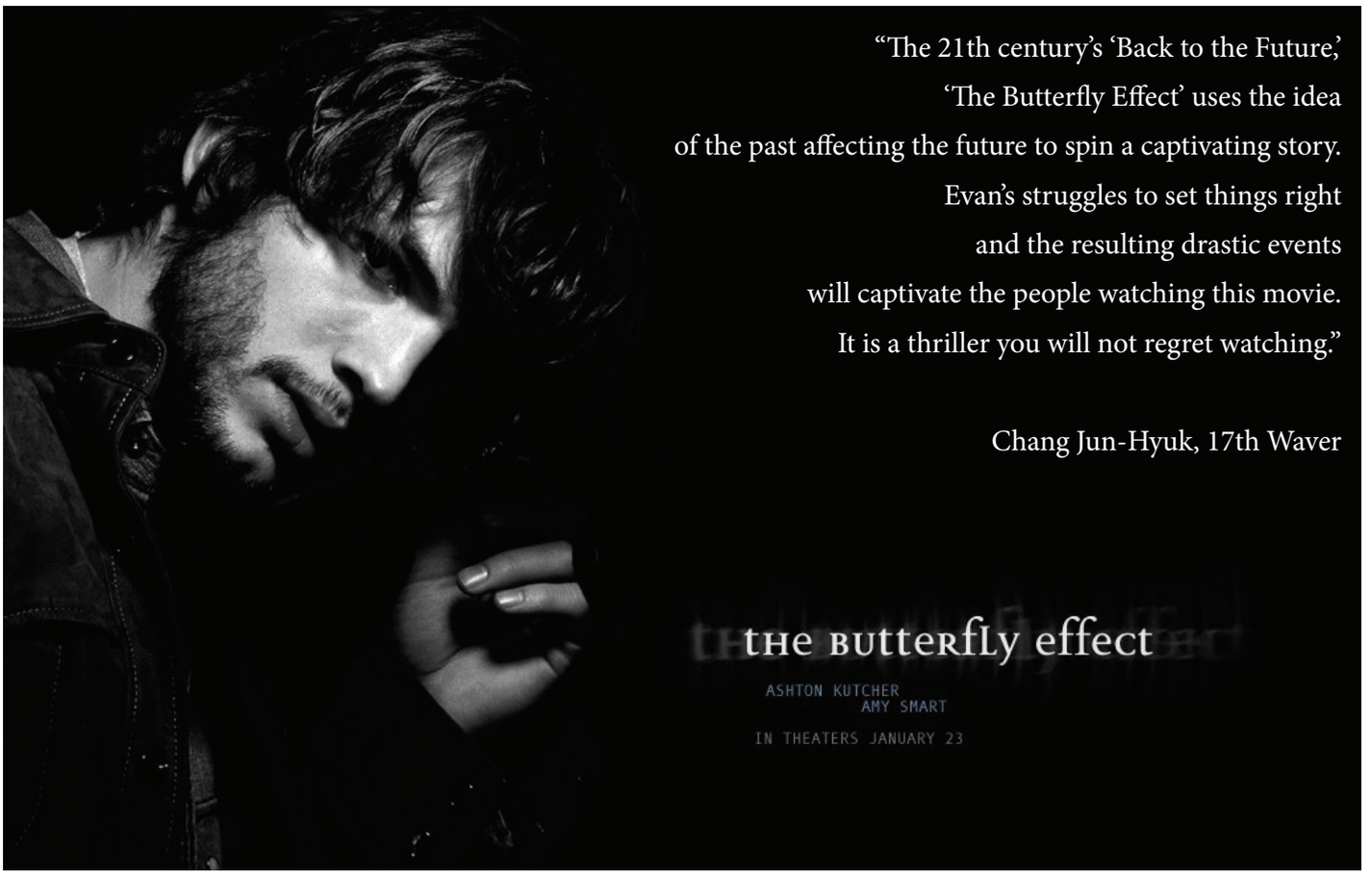
my week with
MARILYN

"If you watch 'My Week with Marilyn'
you will first be hit with the beautiful cinematography
and next with Michelle Williams' superb, mesmerizing acting.
Want to see Marilyn Monroe?
Want to see Michelle Williams' fantastic portrayal of Marilyn Monroe?
Then I highly recommend the movie.
Take a more personal glimpse of Marilyn's charms
that you never knew before."

Eom So-Young, 16th Waver

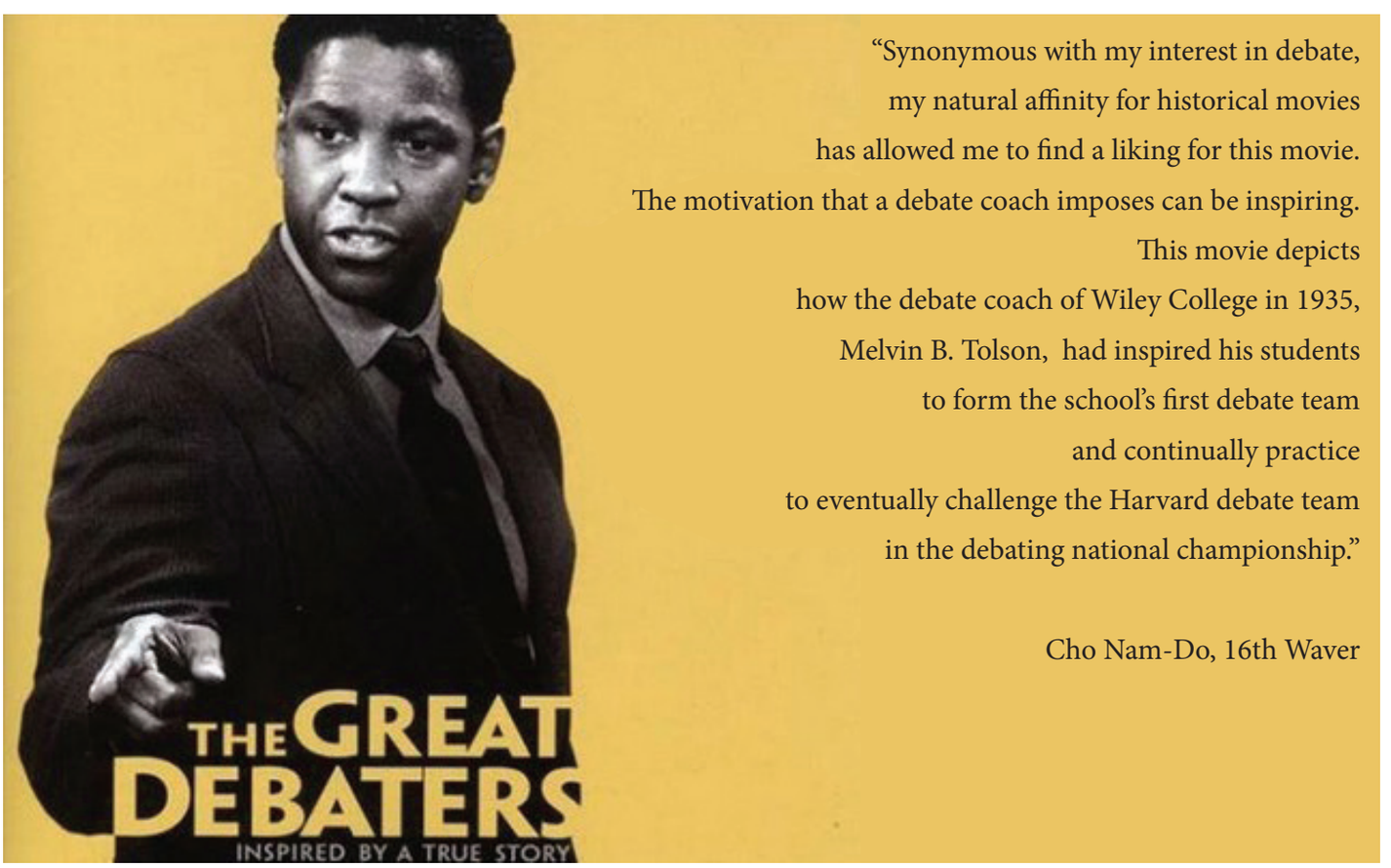
"The classic romance movie.
It's especially perfect when Christmas season is around the corner.
The omnibus story just brings so much spice and sympathizing points to the movie,
and by the end all the episodes culminate
into a lovely mixture of love, warmth, and holiday cheer.
I always watch it on Christmas day and never get tired of it."

Hyun-Jee Kim, 16th Waver



"The 21th century's 'Back to the Future,'
'The Butterfly Effect' uses the idea
of the past affecting the future to spin a captivating story.
Evan's struggles to set things right
and the resulting drastic events
will captivate the people watching this movie.
It is a thriller you will not regret watching."

Chang Jun-Hyuk, 17th Waver



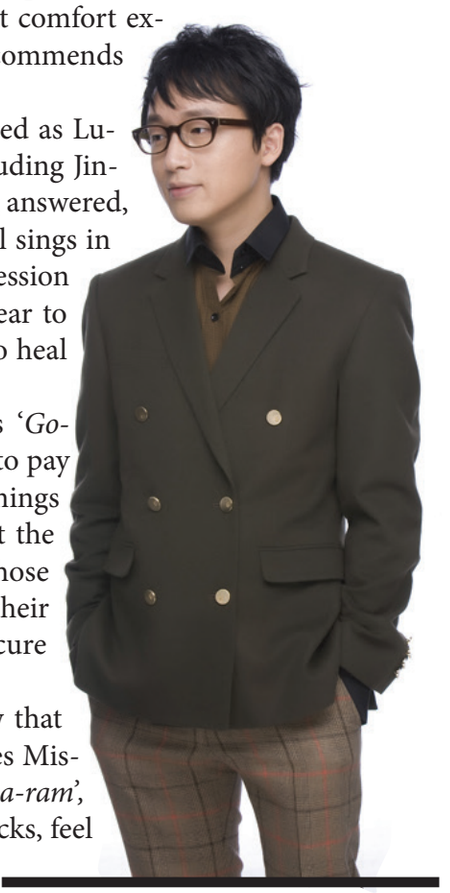
"Synonymous with my interest in debate,
my natural affinity for historical movies
has allowed me to find a liking for this movie.
The motivation that a debate coach imposes can be inspiring.
This movie depicts
how the debate coach of Wiley College in 1935,
Melvin B. Tolson, had inspired his students
to form the school's first debate team
and continually practice
to eventually challenge the Harvard debate team
in the debating national championship."

Cho Nam-Do, 16th Waver

What do YOU Listen to?

Album

What most of KMLA students need in their life is "healing"; from the very start to the end of school life, students suffer under series of quizzes, reports, presentations, club activities, etc. Students "heal" themselves through various methods, such as talking to friends, reading books, or playing sports. One of the most representative ways of healing is listening to music, especially the calm and quiet ones that comfort exhausted minds. Ryu Jin-Gyeong, a renowned music listener in 16th wave, recommends her healing album to KMLA students; "Les Miserables" of Lucid Fall.



Although released more than four years ago, this album is still remembered as Lucid Fall's masterpiece by his fans and many other indie-music listeners, including Jin-Gyeong. When asked the reason why she is healed by this album, Jin-Gyeong answered, "Every song in this album reflects the artist's warm sentimentality." The vocal sings in quiet, plain voice without using special artistic techniques. This gives impression that the singer is narrating his story to listeners, as if he is standing very near to them, to tell what he feels about them, to ensure them he is their side, and to heal them.

"Also, this album sometimes gives lessons," Jin-Gyeong added, "such as '*Go-deung-eo*', both the sixth and title track of "Les Miserables", does – it tells me to pay attention to small things around me, to realize their seemingly-trivial meanings and values." As its title suggests, '*Go-deung-eo*' is a narrative song spoken at the perspective of a fish. The fish talks to those who choose it as a dinner meal, those who are not rich enough to choose expensive meat diets, that it appreciates their another day of hard work. It is surprising how Lucid Fall draws upon words of cure from common fish dish on the dinner table.

"Every single track in this album is must-to-be-heard, but to pick up few that are more recommendable than others," Jin-Gyeong said, "I would suggest 'Les Miserables'—both pt.1 and pt.2—, '*Go-deung-eo*', '*Bom Nun*', '*Pyeong-beom-han Sa-ram*', and '*Oe-tol-i*'." Maybe next time they feel hurt, students can turn on these tracks, feel the same as Jin-gyeong and other fans of Lucid Fall did, and be healed.

Morning Call

At the start of every month, Department of School Broadcasting receives a list of songs that students request for morning calls. This is the idea to encourage students to wake up in pleasant, amusing mind, by listening to their favorite songs. Some students, however, claim that morning calls are often not very effective in awakening students who suffer from all-night studying.

Minjok Herald presented the list of morning calls in October, 2012, and asked the question "What song contributed the most in waking you up?" to 16th and 17th wavers. 42 percent of the total respondents answered "Chui Jung Jin Dam". This song, actually, is not a formal music file sung by Kim Dong-Ryul but a recorded file sung by Lee Jun-Gun of 16th wave. Cho Jeong-Hoon, 16th waver, even commented that this song "was the only morning call I heard last year".

It is good to wake up in the morning, listening to popular songs such as "All For You" or "Defying Gravity". And yet, sometimes it is more effective, and perhaps even more amusing, to wake up listening to their friend's voice. But it must be reminded that this method should be used very carefully and rarely, because some people—including Mr. Kim, the dorm parent—may be not prepared to "enjoy" a student's song.

KMLA Freshmen Juniors Seniors

Yoo Sun Sung

Like Our Page,
MinjokHerald

Greeting the Return of our Old Family

Last year, the 16th wavers welcomed a number of new faces:
transfer students from diverse backgrounds.
Well, this year is quite different.
The 17th wave, as they are ascending to their junior year,
greets three 'seniors,' 16th wavers,
who have returned from their time off from school.
This is an especially unique trait for the 17th wavers
since two 16th wavers, Sung Si-Yun and Joo-Hyun Jeong,
have already joined the 17th wave last year,
making a total of five students mingling with younger friends.
In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA),
students are allowed to take a resting period
for a remaining year and return next year.
Let's take a peek at their lives back in KMLA.

Junior Writer,
Lee Chang-Hun, 17th Wave

Ko Hae-Wook

MH: How are you approaching the 17th wavers?
HW: I don't want to be rash in making friends with them. I want to slowly approach them with patience, through knowing each other thoroughly.

MH: What did you normally do during your rest?
HW: I listened to music, participated in community service programs, and filled my academic gaps through studying.

MH: What did you learn through your rest?
HW: I learned to look at things without frills.

MH: Without frills? What does that mean?
HW: It means that I learned to view things as they are, without any decoration.

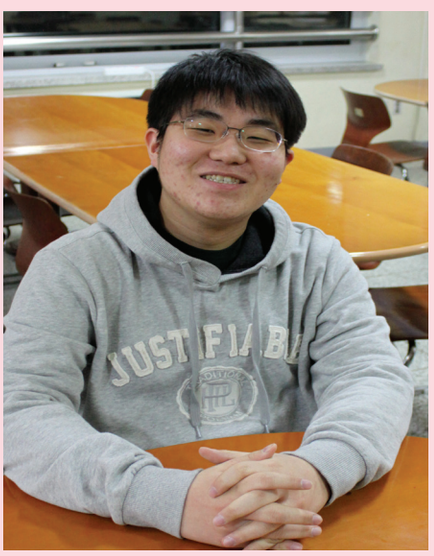
MH: What did you miss about KMLA?
HW: I missed hanging out with people. To be specific, I missed Samuchim a lot. In Samuchim, I practiced very hard and I learned to collaborate with others to produce a work. I didn't have the opportunity to do such things when I was resting.

MH: Are you satisfied with your roommates?
HW: Of course, they are Choi Jee Woong and Lee Changhun, and I'm really fortunate to have them as my roommates.

MH: What would be the positive side of resting for a year and coming back?
HW: In GLPS, I heard from a sunbae who graduated that life in KMLA is something that I will never experience again. I think it's certainly a good thing that I am having this valuable experience for a longer time.

MH: Lastly, would you briefly introduce yourself for most 17th wavers who still don't much about you?
HW: All the 17th wavers I have met so far are really nice. I wish to befriend them and get to know all of them.

Park Jae-Yong



MH: How has your life in KMLA been so far since you came back?
JY: Well, I guess the first few weeks are about making new friends. I'm getting to know more 17th wavers, so I guess I'm rolling along.

MH: What do you think is the biggest difference between the 17th wave and 16th wave in terms of the general ambience?
JY: Since I haven't spent a lot of time with the 17th wave, I can't say for sure. But I felt that 17th wavers are better at suppressing their cravings to play. For example, they tend to play less game and choose to study instead.

MH: How have you changed through the resting period?
JY: The most significant change would be my appearance. I lost 15kg during my rest.

MH: 15kg? I think a lot of students, especially the girls, would be interested in how you lost so much weight. Can you give them a tip?
JY: I actually had some health problem, so losing weight was the result of my treatment. I frequently went to the fitness center, which I enjoyed a lot. Besides that, I also controlled my diet, such as not eating junk food.

MH: Did you miss KMLA?
JY: Of course. The thing that I missed most was the livelihood of KMLA. I didn't have a lot of interaction with other people during my rest. So it's really great to experience this liveliness again. Especially, my roommates are always loud and cheerful, which I enjoy very much.

MH: How do you want to be called by the 17th wavers.
JY: I wish they would call me Hyeong instead of Sunbae. The word Sunbae somehow creates some gaps. I also prefer Banmal to Jondaemal. I hope they would feel free to approach me.

MH: Lastly, would you briefly introduce yourself for most 17th wavers who still don't much about you?
JY: I may look introverted at first, but I'm actually an animated and even a wild person. I enjoy taking photos and exercising. I hope we all get to know each other.

MH: Thank you for your time!

Jung Seung-Won

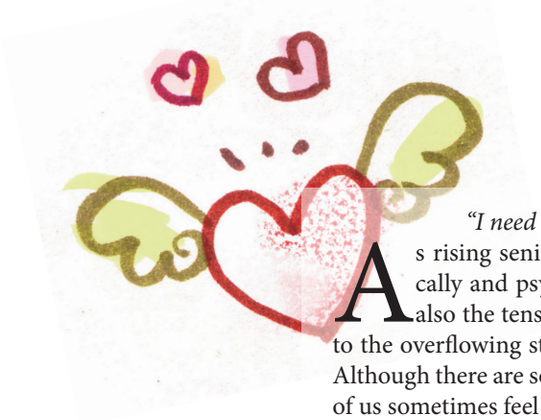
MH: How are you integrating into the 17th wavers?
SW: Well, it's not really easy as they all know each other already and I don't even know all the names. But my roommates are helping me out and I think it's getting better.

MH: How has your rest affected you?
SW: It allowed me to gather myself. I also consider it a huge chance since I can go back and spend my semester again from the start.

MH: How do you want to be called by the 17th wave?
SW: Please call me Unni. It doesn't matter whether you use Banmal or Jondaemal; just talk to me in a way that makes you comfortable.

MH: Lastly, would you briefly introduce yourself for most 17th wavers who still don't much about you?
SW: I don't talk a lot yet, but I'm really an interesting person. You will be surprised by my liveliness when you get to know me. I was actually born in 1996, so treat me as a friend. Also, although I tend to use English a lot, don't think that I am bragging; I'm not really used to speaking Korean yet.

MH: Thank you for your time. We wish you good lick for the rest of your life in KMLA!



The New Lesson

"I need someone to listen to me, sympathize with me, and heal me."

As rising seniors, we start to face much more difficulties in school life, both physically and psychologically. Not only the amount of general workload increases, but also the tension and competition begin to rise. We tend to lose our composure due to the overflowing stress. This phenomenon is natural, and has been there for many years. Although there are some students who can strongly overcome the stress by themselves, most of us sometimes feel so exhausted that we want some "healing" in our lives. For the concept of healing has been necessary for both seniors and other students in KMLA, I would want to share my special memory of healing.

Looking back, I always wanted others to heal me whenever I felt discouraged; I was depending too much on my friends and their power of healing. Indeed, it was the end of the last semester when I had a chance to get healed in a different way.

Manitto session was an official event in which all students had to blindly pick one person in different gender, and secretly help him or her in some sense. Since this period allowed us to exchange letters and presents among boys and girls without school's restriction, some students tried hard to choose their crush. Frankly, I happened to pick a boy whom I barely knew; I decided to give him typical Manitto presents with short letters.

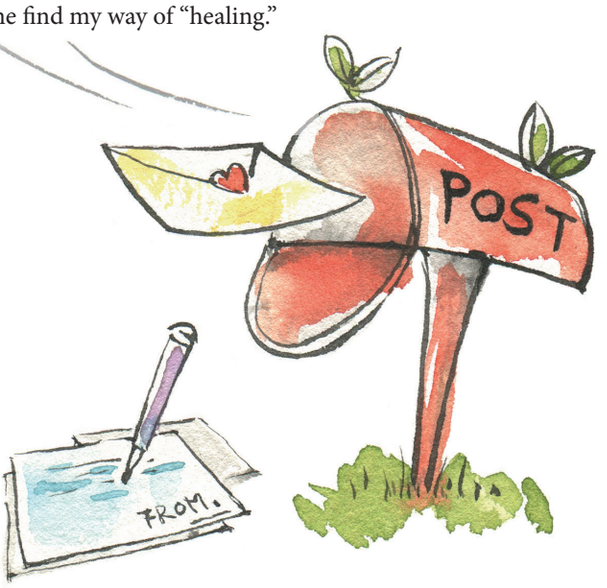
At first, I wrote superficial letters with usual greetings. The first three letters were mere repetitions of encouragement for him to study harder without stress. As time flew and the number of my letters increased, however, I began to include some of my stories. The letters became more like my personal journal, reflecting what happened each day. They were now part of my daily routine. I automatically started to put some deeper concerns that I could not share with my closest friends. Since I was not planning to reveal myself forever, I could easily write my genuine thoughts that were normally embarrassing to say. He was not the kind of person who would respond enthusiastically, but rather read them quietly. This made me feel even more comfortable to share my stories.

My writing those letters, which might seem to be a $0.02 experience for other people, taught me new ways of healing. For two different ways, this healed me even more than receiving letters from others. That there was someone somewhere reading my letters, listening to me, somehow gave me a consolation. It probably would not have mattered who that was; his existence itself was a relief for my barren life. Interacting with him was a precious opportunity for me.

Another thing was my self-realization. In the past, I tried to get encouraged by other people, always conscious of how they would think of me. While writing letters, however, I had a chance to reflect my day and think more deeply about how I should live. Although letters only took me 10 to 20 minutes to complete, I spent more than an hour looking back on my life more seriously. What I learned through that process was that there were not only my friends, teachers or family members, but also I to stand for myself. Realizing that I was both the greatest supporter and watcher of my life, I promised to live a life that would not be embarrassing when reminiscing the past at the end of my life.

The Manitto session ended quietly, and my Manitee and I are not yet the closest friends in school; we just know each other. The experience of writing letters for him, however, still remains in my heart as a great lesson for me. It was significant not only because there was someone to listen to my story, but also because I learned how to heal myself by believing in me and my life. I feel thankful for his whole being, helping me find my way of "healing."

Park Jung-Min
16th Wave



The Twelfth Hour : Nightmare

Park Ji-Sun
First Place Winner, 18th Wave

A belle bell rings
It's 6 o' clock, time to dine

Over the valley an anonym tugs the arrow
I ask; you I hear echo, notice the sorrow?

Youthful days, faithful nights,
Those seasons that never betrayed me
Pray you, remember me.

Now I see the invincible heights
Where are hawks to bring peak to me?
Pray you, remember me.

And I now face the snow
Beyond the storm, anyone know?
What will crack that malicious tain
And allow transparency give my gain?

Every future obscure,
Every tellings insecure,
Will northern lights glow back
Through these piled tasks in stack?

Just then a caring voice
Approaches, says, 'rejoice.'
Shutting the inner gloominess down
It disturbs the mind tristful gems are sown.

How?
How shall I enjoy?

You diverged from home to here,
Rigorously brief sleeps
Provoking amounts of works
Severe, intensive bodily tirings
Marvelously stressing competes
And finally, the irresistible dignity of
Those palatable meals as recompense -
The evil spoke.

So it was me who was guilty
Struggling to reject tranquility
Of eagerly endured stresses;
To anxiety I now pay addresses.

The night passes, I devote
Myself to this passionate lust.

The belle bell rings
It's 6 o' clock, time to rise.

The belle bell rings
The grateful morrow has again come
Thy graceful sparrow flits to the cold air.

Wake up.

Spring Comes

Sul Yu-Bin, First Place Winner, 18th Wave

For The Future School Club Fairs To Come

School Club Fair Needs a Systematic Set of Rules and Planning for Future Success

'Study not for personal gain but for the sake of learning itself'

This phrase, which most of the students should be familiar with, thoroughly summarizes the various activities that take place in KMLA: because the students value not only academics but also diverse experiences as an important part of learning, students ardently engage themselves in many different activities ranging from playing violin to building houses. Thus, club activities are a big part for most of the students at KMLA, supported by the fact that almost 100 different clubs exist. The School Club Fair was first established last year, in order to reduce the inefficiencies of club advertising and freshmen sign-ups. The School Club Fair is a chance for all the clubs to directly advertise themselves to the students, and the freshmen to get to know the many clubs in school. But this year's School Club Fair seemed to have been insufficient in fulfilling its initial purpose: due to time and space constraints most of the clubs – except the performance clubs- weren't given the fair chance to represent themselves.

The School Club Fair clearly demonstrates the school's lack of consideration for official Saturday events. The School Club Fair, which took place at the gym last year, had to be moved to Dasan and Chungmu Halls because the hotel which had lent desks last year couldn't afford to do so this year. Had the school asked a little earlier to the hotel whether they could lend desks or not, it would have been easier for the Club Union, a group that managed the overall Fair, to plan and settle the Fair more thoroughly. The confusion in the attendance check of the 16th wavers also reflected the school's insufficient attention towards the Fair. The attendance checking method or time which are always determined by the school in all other events, was finally settled by the Club Union, struggling between two different directions from teachers. Hence, a more systematic planning and preparation for the Fair is required to prevent misunderstandings and confusion.

The performance clubs were also partly responsible for the inefficient School Club Fair. The non-performance clubs weren't able to introduce themselves in front of all the 18th wavers because the performance clubs used more than their assigned time. Whereas the time was limited to 7 minutes including the preparation time, all the performance clubs except one used more than the limited time. The performance clubs' unwise attempt to advertise their clubs more led to the involuntary sacrifice of the non-performance clubs' chances to introduce themselves.

Not that the performance clubs are the only one's to take the blame. The Club Union's almost impossible schedule made it almost inevitable for the Schol Club Fair to go amuck. The Club Union was responsible for the overall management and control of the fair., and thus it was the Club Union that was supposed to be in charge of flexibly adjusting the planned schedule according to the situation at the Fair. In other words, the Club Union was responsible for strictly cutting the performances of the clubs which were using more than the allotted time. Also, the original one minute restraint for the non-performance clubs was irrational. Who would expect clubs to use exactly one minute without some deviation? However, considering that the job this big of a scale was assigned to only two students, such result wasn't totally unexpected.

However, the rather negative result of the School Club Fair was redeemed to an extent. Most of the clubs didn't have difficulty in recruiting new members, largely due to the school club book the Club Union had published. The original purpose of the School club Fair, equal opportunity to advertise clubs, was further supported by the additional club advertising time prepared by the Club Union. Thus, the impending problems were temporarily solved – now, we should focus in ways to prevent similar problems from occurring in the next School Club Fair.

First, the establishment of rules regarding the introduction time and booth management is necessary. This year's fair had some conflicts between the clubs regarding the acceptable limit of club advertisement, and the Club Union was unable to come up with a rule by itself. Second, more systematic planning of the School Club Fair is needed. The setting and the conditions of the fair should be decided earlier, and increase in the number of the students engaging in the general management of the fair can be another solution as well.

The assessment of this year's School Club Fair may differ from student to student, and from club to club. However, one point is certain: next year's School Club Fair can be better, and this year's Fair would certainly contribute in setting a better guideline for the future School Club Fairs to come.

Staff Editorialist
Lee Chung Hyun,16th wave

Time for the Council to Go Silent

Give Voice to the Students During Q&A Sessions

Chunks of seats, seats fully reserved for, are empty. The air is cold, even chilling. It's as if the famous lyrics of Simon and Garfunkel's "Sound of Silence" have turned into a reality. The speakers talk, but they don't speak. The audience hears, but they don't listen. Words are voiced, but their meanings are never shared. Most of the time, the audience seems to be out of focus and preoccupied; it reacts only very rarely. When the speaker fumbles to find the right word, the audience looks away in disappointment. When the speaker looks back at his or her script, the crowd jeers. When the speaker makes a brave move, the crowd oohs; when the speaker makes a mistake, it boos.

This is not a scene of some sloppy neighborhood circus. It is neither a B-rate, badly-failing talk show. This is the striking portrait of what defines, what holds up, what is the most fundamental ground of KMLA's so greatly cherished "student autonomy" – the election speech sessions.

The speech and Q & A sessions for the election of the 15th student council were respectively held on the first self-study periods of February 18th and 20th. For the 17th wavers, it was already the third election; for the 18th wavers, the very first. The attitudes of the curious freshmen were relatively acceptable, but those of the juniors, sadly, were not. In stark contrast between the two waves was the surprisingly large number of empty chairs that should have been filled without exception – indeed a reserved seat. It was a downright, in-your-face type of violation, and yet, without any proper attendance check, none of the over ten people who were missing from their chairs were ever punished afterwards. While the candidates were nervously presenting their passion to the students, according to a testament from an anonymous junior, a group of boys were ignorantly idling on the 11th floor.

The more serious problem, however, was with the students who were present. The student members of the Department of Student Guidance, during every moment of the sessions, busily walked along the aisles to catch and stop students who were playing mobile games, dozing, or reading books; students simply not paying attention were out of question – there were just too many of them to catch. When asked about the attitude of the students during the sessions, the chief of the Department of Student Guidance answered with forlorn pessimism: "The students was so unmanageably out of order that some of the members of our department even were skeptical of patrolling and attempting to correct the students' attitudes at all. I think everybody kind of knows already that the sessions are a mess; I just don't think we students are mature enough to participate in these kinds of discussions with reasonable respect." The failure of the sessions – whether it was of the students or of the system – was painfully obvious.

The first accusation against the students, the rhetoric that the students' lack of will to participate is the cause of failure, has now become a hackneyed topic in Minjok Herald pages – indeed, it is as clichéd as the complaint that the school authority accounts for all the dysfunctions of the student council. In this semester's sessions, however, neither was culpable; for many, the student council's organization of the sessions was a significant factor that disabled the proper workings of student autonomy.

It had clear and several shortcomings when it came to generating participation from the students. During the Q & A sessions, of the three branches of the student council, only the Judicial Branch allotted time for questions from the audience, and the other two skipped such chances because of "time constraints." Most of the two hours were spent exclusively by the members of the present student council asking their self-constructed questions to prospective candidates, several among them questions that seemed to test only litheness and wit. The candidates for the Judicial Branch were asked what animal they thought each other were; those for the Executive Branch were asked to compare themselves to a drink. Those who had prepared in advance questions for the candidates were never given the chance to speak, and many important and controversial issues raised from the candidates' written submissions were left untouched when time expired.

In other words, in a mandatory session where students were to be an integral part of the process, they were left spectators. Undoubtedly, such concern was raised publicly in the KMLA Forum almost immediately afterwards by an anonymous person, most likely a 17th waver, who in his or her post stated that "the students were not participating in the sessions simply as idling spectators that filled up the background like folding screens, but as proactive main agents of school politics." The post continued to make the point that many questions were "in effect unrelated to student autonomy." Is it possible for students to speak and listen when all the talk is done by a small clique of current and future student council members?

Of course the student council does not merit all the blame for how the sessions turned out – every participant had its flaws, made its mistakes. Yet the current student council should not forget that a transformation in the organization of the sessions is an inevitable, first-priority task for a truly fruitful operation of student autonomy in next semester's election.

Junior Editorialist
Sung Ho-Kyung, 17th Wave

Always at a Stop

Why Change Cannot Take Place

On February 25th, citizens of the Republic of Korea looked on as Park Geun-Hye took office as the newly elected 18th president. Claiming to open a "new era of hope" by rejuvenating our economy and flourishing our culture, she set forth ambitious plans to improve the nation. A few days back, she had introduced a government restructuring plan as a cornerstone of executing her policies. Although Park Geun-hye insisted that such restructuring was crucial to the development of the nation, many people a clash of values was prevalent. Let us stop there and zoom out of Seoul. If we dive in to the woods of Gangwon Province and narrow down our view until two buildings with blue roofs come into focus, we've come to the right place. As always, one student council term is just on the verge of ending and another one stands ready to take over the job. As a KMLA student that has witnessed both events at once, I cannot help but compare the two.

Park Geun-Hye's presidency did not start off so smoothly. There was a conflict over the government restructuring plan, which thus failed to pass at the National Assembly's plenary session. One of the biggest concerns was that of the trade division removal from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade. One MOFAT official claimed that "it has nearly been 15 years since the Ministry of Trade and Ministry of Foreign Affairs were united into one, and dividing the two at this point is bound to create many problems for the nation." The original purpose that Kim Dae-Jung proposed for uniting the two ministries was to carry out both tasks in a holistic way in order to enhance efficiency. For 15 years, the newly united ministry proposed plans and executed actions that could lead to successful cooperation and balance between the two tasks. However, now that MOFAT is trying to bring about the results of such cooperation, Park Geun-Hye has prevented them from doing so.

Coming back to KMLA: On February 22nd, an election was held to determine the representatives of the 15th executive, legislative, and judicial councils. Although it is great to have fresh new members that are passionate to bring about change, a tinge of regret remains within the student council. With only six months per term, the previous members of the student council have not had enough time to fully implement their policies. When asked if the 14th legislative council had fulfilled all of its policy commitments, legislative president Lee Ha-Jung replied that such was not the case. Not only had the policies been unrealistic, but there had been no time for the realistic ones as well. For example, her policies regarding class meetings that take place every week were not put into effect because of their lack of reality. Thus, most of the early period of her term was spent on recognizing the limits of what can and cannot be done, and the members had to agree among themselves regarding the method of running the council. 14th executive vice president Jang Hye-Jin also said that "the policies of new candidates are somewhat idealistic." Judging from the facts, it is reasonable to conclude that the student representatives are provided with so little a time to make actual realistic changes to the school. When they are just about to understand the boundaries of change and the proper way to function as a school branch, new idealistic members squeeze in and eventually push the original members off the edge.

However, good news remain: most of the 15th student council candidates offered certain policies that are extensions of those of the 14th student council, or at least policies that slightly modify the limitations of previous ones. This shows the whole school how much our future representatives understand the hardships of policy executions and how genuine they are regarding their jobs.

This isn't to say that a policy must be a mere copy of those of others. I myself am a fervent admirer of adventure and challenge. However, the important message here is that policies must be practical and be in accordance with previous policies to bring about real change. They should not be a means of populism to entice the voters, no less an empty policy that goes against the flow of the past. Just like the clashes that Park Geun-Hye's reshuffle caused, a policy that changes everything of the past will be turbulence rather than transformation.

Staff Editorialist
Suh Yeon-Soo, 16th Wave

Why Enrolling in Hagwons Should Be Discouraged

Nowadays, KMLA students seem to pass on going to hagwons as a matter of course. Enrolling in various hagwons during vacation is now regarded as a de facto requisite for every student regardless of grade or field, and some even go to hagwons in weekends during the school year. Despite this prevalent affiliation of hagwons, the school constantly discourages students from attending hagwons especially through morning speeches. Just what aspect of this school-wide, or perhaps nation-wide phenomenon is so detrimental to make the school reprimand enrolling in hagwons recurrently?

It is true that some of the reasons that the school principal mentioned in his speeches against going to hagwons has aroused prolific controversies. In one speech, he claimed that there is no need for students to go to hagwons because KMLA provides various classes of nation's best quality. Although this may be a valid argument for some students, a little inquiry into the reasons behind going to hagwons shows how this claim fails to aptly address the kernel of the issue. Students don't go to hagwons because they want to get sufficient scores or grades; they go to hagwons to be better than their competitors. KMLA does offer its students top quality classes, but that doesn't distinguish the students from fellow KMLA students.

Let's look into the underlying motive behind going to hagwons a bit more. Why do students go to hagwons? As we are all aware of, Korean society is a dog-eat-dog society with extremely high emphasis on education. Just as the old saying, 'devil takes the hindmost', everyone strives not to fall behind in daily competitions with each other. Enrolling in hagwons is, therefore, perhaps inevitable because it is the only means for one to become more competent. Moreover, the ever-increasing percentage of students attending hagwons also tempts students who initially studied by themselves to enroll in hagwons. By now, it is not an exaggeration to say that going to hagwons have become a social norm for all students.

Nonetheless, this is exactly the reason why enrolling in hagwons should be reproved and discouraged. A society that directly and indirectly impels students to attend hagwons is never a healthy society, let alone a commendable one. Enrolling in hagwons may enhance one's productivity, but it equally takes away the opportunity to trust his or her ability, increase sense of independence, and demonstrate self-control. Nation-wide recognition that hagwons are inevitable is a dire symptom of a diseased society that deserves full attention.

Another devastating consequences of a prevalent reliance on hagwons is that it could make rich man richer and poor man poorer. Granted, hagwons can provide profound assistance to students. The problem, however, appears because hagwons do not offer assistances of equal quality - and often, hagwons that are capable of helping students profoundly tend to be many times more expensive than the cost of those that aren't. Thus, while students from affluent families enjoy such high-quality assistances and easily obtain notable test scores and grades, students from economically unfortunate families must live with what they could afford. Moreover, most KMLA students do not attend hagwons individually; they usually form a small group and ask hagwons to open a class specifically designed for them. Since these classes are often more expensive, many KMLA students are always on a tight budget. As long as this discrepancy in educational qualities exists, the gap between the rich and the poor will never shorten.

By saying so, however, I'm neither denying the substantial assistance that hagwons can provide to students nor calling for a complete eradication of hagwons. What I do suggest, nevertheless, is to keep in mind that we cannot rely on hagwons forever and that the option of studying by oneself still remains. Hagwons are not requirements to receive satisfactory grades or scores. For instance, getting a substantial score in SAT I, a test that all international universities require, or Korean history qualification test that many domestic students take, is definitely possible without going to hagwons.

"I am not sure about students these days, but I definitely know that there had been a number of students who received sufficient SAT I scores without ever attending hagwons – they studied by themselves," said Mr. Jung Key-One, the newly elected international college counselor.

"Studying by yourself might be more of a burden because hagwons give you test information as well as well-organized textbooks. But honestly, I think if you study hard enough for the Korean history class for the 11th graders, it's not so hard to pass the test," replied one student, who passed the Korean history qualification test recently.

As the aforementioned examples and arguments illustrates, a heavy reliance on hagwons is a slippery slope both individually and socially. Seeking advice and assistances from hagwons occasionally is fine, but do not make your life be dominated by hagwons. Trust yourself and believe in your capabilities and potentials. It may sound like a cliché, but it is actually a tall order that is essential for success.

Junior Opinion Writer
Cho Seung-Hyun,17th wave

How we became Unfresh

In retrospect of year 2012, by a 17th waver

'Sorry for writing this ddongguel, but I can't help it.'
'I'm amazed that I'm alive.'

There were times when we needed healing. There were times when our Facebook walls were overflowing with moans. Moving into a completely new environment and spending the busiest schedule ever among totally new people wasn't easy for any of us to handle. Starting from early February, we were separated from our middle school friends and all the graduation parties, and were thrown all of a sudden into something called a preparation period. Personally, I felt as if I had fallen through the rabbit hole just like Alice in Wonderland.

Moving into the full semester, numerous school events and enormous amounts of quizzes, papers suffocated us. They all came at once: it never came one by one. Having those workloads piling up, I felt, and probably every 17th waver felt helpless like a child alone in a storm. This was particularly intense when the test period approached. Teachers started to assign more homework, extracurricular activities were at its peak, and we had to start preparing for our regular tests. Tiredness and melancholy frustration slipped through our weaknesses (especially after harsh morning exercises) probably because we freshmen did not have any kind of immunity to such sequence of things-to-do. Thus, it was obvious that we were all contracted with 'deprivation of self-confidence', 'feelings of shame', and 'emotional turmoil' at the middle of this pandemonium. These maladies tormented us for months, until vacations came close by.

However, having past a year in this school, now I understand how much these unique traditions, and seemingly turbulent experiences has molded me into a mature person. Before I even realized, and whether it was my own will or not, I was slowly growing to become a component of the fast-moving clock of KMLA. The tradition was there for us to remind us of our lost identities. With the traditions, I learnt to respect others, and learnt that this respect was the foundation of every personal relationship. An individual was to be respected only if they respect others. And most importantly, by the turbulent experiences, I learnt to respect myself. Without believing in me, nothing could be done. There is no need to break down my mental state with frustration and sense of failure. All I needed to do was to encourage myself to keep walking. Nothing more, and nothing less. Everyone has their own life, and we should not be hastened by other's speed. We are the owners of our life.

Aside from the distressing moments, there were also times when we were inundated with joy. A year spent in KMLA has not only left us with scars, but also with precious memories and lessons. First and foremost, true friends. Except for few who came from dormitories, most of our school students never had any past dormitory experiences other than KMLA. Hence, having family members replaced by peers was totally refreshing. It was something more than sharing private space with whom I had no knowledge about. Dormitory life for a year has already created life-lasting friends, unforgettable birthday parties, healing conversations, lots of crying and lots of laughter that would pop up in my mind sporadically. Though we also had to share our dark sides, they were mostly understood, and embraced. It truly feels as if we are really a family, encountering each other so often and so in depth. We are, KMLA family. Even during our vision trip - spending weeks in another country with peers, we had times to discover more about ourselves and our friends. We also could put down the burdens of school life for a while. Talking with our seniors in foreign universities, and listening to their dreams and what they are currently achieving, I got chances to look back at my short-sighted dreams. University wasn't the end of our life. After the trip, I could reset myself to the fluttery state, just as I was when applying for KMLA. A dream was meant to be big.

We have now officially gone through one third, or two thirds of our high school year. Though we are now unfresh, we mustn't forget how beautiful KMLA was on our first day of orientation, and the fresh minds we had when entering the school. We shouldn't loosen ourselves. Now that we have 18th wavers to live with us, our responsibility lies on us much harder. As juniors, we 17th wavers must keep in mind that we are no longer fresh enough to lean on somebody else. It is our time to lend our shoulders to others. And thank you for 16th wavers, who now became seniors, for giving us so much help to go through our first years of high school. Hope you manage your last year wisely, and step closer to your dreams. Lastly, for fresh freshmen, welcome, and wish you the best luck for your first year in this school. Please be awesome, 2013!

Kim Ha-Young
Junior Opinion Writer, 17th Wave

Growing Up with Stress

Let Stress Be Your Advocate

The three last years of teenage, seventeen, eighteen, and nineteen, are the years of uncertainties, aimless wanderings, and worries. "Whoever wants to be born, must destroy a world," said Demian. The road in front of us that had always seemed to be the right one is suddenly full of doubtful mist, and when we look around, few other roads that exist are even darker and mistier. Demian might tell us to listen to our hearts and live with the a m of finding our true selves, but his advice is easily ignored in front of the tangible reality of Calculus quiz tomorrow and essay assignment due in two days. Starting from having to wake up at 6 every morning, stress builds up as we must attend morning exercises, take care of penalty points, participate in club activities, and do mountains of homework and studying.

However, it is hard to imagine life without daily duties. We suffer from stress, but most of us usually face it, although with different attitudes. Why do we fight stress?

We fight stress because we have ambitions. People without aims do not get stressed, since they are satisfied with the present and wish to stay the same in the future. Stress results after paying effort to improve: after practicing for hours to pass the kendo test, or after enduring the temptations of Honjeong bread. Thus, stress is not a direct product of the environment. It is a combination of the environment and the will of individuals to overcome the environment. In other words, stress results when a person actively tries to find a way out of his or her hardship.

So stress is a sign of positive energy to do better in life. But, many will still say, stress is far from anything positive in their lives. The experiment on dragonfly larvae by Professor Shannon McCully of Toronto University, like many other experiments on stress, clearly showed the negative effect of stress on mental health. The research team divided the larvae into two groups. Group 1 was placed in a water tank with fish, the larvae's predator, placed in one side. Although there was a division curtain in between the spaces for larvae and fish, the division was not perfect and was transparent. So, the larvae of group 1 received continuous stress by the presence of their predator. Group 2, however, was left alone. The research team provided a suitable environment for both groups of larvae to grow into adult dragonflies. The number of deaths before developing into adult dragonfly was 2.5~ 4.3 times higher in group 1 than group 2. According to this experiment, the strained environment itself was a reason enough for the extreme stress and deaths of larvae.

However, we are not weak larvae. We are not threatened by the fear of death every moment. What makes us weak in front of stress is our tendency to over-value and feel over-burdened by the events and duties of life. Often, when scrolling through facebook, I find many depressed comments on how hard the week will be, how difficult the quiz was, or etc. Although one might want others' attention and consolation, it is still hard to understand why one would deliberately put oneself in a pathetic situation and practice self-pity. When one is stressed, one must push forward, rather than reside in gloom. This is especially true in KMLA; every day, in every aspect of life, something will make you want to sit down and do nothing. When such tendency of idleness builds up, it will soon make your stress deep-reaching and unfathomable. That is when stress becomes really bad, devoid of any energy.

During the three years in KMLA, everyone goes through a slump. It might come in the first semester and quickly go away, or it might come in the second semester to threaten you until the sophomore year. It might even appear in the third year. When slump comes, do not let it build a wall high up in your minds. Do not get depressed by a layer added on the wall, but gather energy to break down two layers. Then, you will be able to control stress and break free from the egg.

Lim Chae-Won
Junior Opinion Writer, 17th Wave